

NICHE LAUNCH BRIEF

Nurse Humor - Night Shift Dark Humor Apparel

Generated: 2026-04-02
Status: Ready for Operator Review

1. Niche Decision

Verdict: GO - with targeted sub-niche focus

POS Score: 26/40

Factor	Score /10	Notes
Demand	8	Top-25 Etsy POD keyword; Nurses Week spike; evergreen base
Competition	5	Broad market saturated; dark humor / specialty sub-niches viable
Margin	6	Sweatshirt 28.6%; tee 43.1%; mug needs COGS confirmed
Differentiation	7	Night shift + dark humor combo; NICU under-served

Key Risks:

- Broad nurse shirt keywords are saturated. Success requires long-tail SEO (NICU, night shift, sarcastic). Use eRank or Marmalead before publishing.
- Nurses Week (first week of May) is the primary sales spike - listings must be live ASAP to accumulate impressions in time.
- Mug margin is fragile at mid COGS (\$22 AUD). Confirm actual Gelato AU mug cost in your Gelato dashboard before listing mugs.

2. Unit Economics

Per-Unit Profit (AUD)

Product	Retail	COGS	Etsy Fees	Net Profit	Margin
Night Shift Sweatshirt	\$70	\$43	\$6.98	\$20.02	28.6%
NICU Nurse T-Shirt	\$45	\$21	\$4.61	\$19.39	43.1%
Nurse Mug (low COGS \$17)	\$33	\$17	\$3.47	\$12.53	38.0%
Nurse Mug (mid COGS \$22)	\$33	\$22	\$3.47	\$7.53	22.8%

Sweatshirt Monthly Scenarios

Scenario	Units/month	Monthly Revenue	Net Profit/month
A - Early stage	5	\$350	\$100
B - Growing	20	\$1,400	\$400

C - Established	50	\$3,500	\$1,001
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Nurses Week (May) = ~2x normal monthly units. Gelato+ subscription (\$36 AUD/mo) breaks even at 5 sweatshirts/month.

3. Design Briefs - Operator Action Required

Create 3 print-ready PNG files using either: (A) AI image prompts below in ChatGPT or Midjourney, then upscale via upscale.media or bigjpg.com, OR (B) build in Canva using the font and colour specs.

Product 1 - Night Shift Nurse Crewneck Sweatshirt

Phrase: "Night Shift Nurse: Fuelled by Coffee, Spite, and the Sound of Monitors"

Canvas size	4500 x 5400 px 300 DPI PNG transparent
Filename	nurse-nightshift-sweatshirt-v1.png
Hero mockup	Dark Heather Grey (Gildan 18000)
Style	Clean bold typography, white + pale blue text, minimal moon or ECG icon
Fonts (Canva)	Montserrat ExtraBold (header label) + Big Shoulders Display ExtraBold (main text)
Colours	#FFFFFF white + #A8C4D4 pale blue accent

AI Prompt:

Flat lay apparel graphic for dark heather grey crewneck sweatshirt. Clean modern typographic print - no cartoons, no clipart, no gradients. White and pale blue text. Stacked text: NIGHT SHIFT NURSE (small caps header) then large bold display: Fuelled by Coffee, / Spite, / and the Sound / of Monitors. Small outline-only crescent moon or ECG flatline icon. Editorial streetwear style. Transparent background. NO stethoscopes, syringes, or decorative borders.

Product 2 - Sarcastic Nurse Coffee Mug (11oz)

Phrase: "Coffee: Because Stabbing People is Frowned Upon (But I Have a Needle License)"

Canvas size	3600 x 1800 px (wrap) or 1600 x 1400 px (front panel) 300 DPI PNG
Filename	nurse-coffee-mug-v1.png
Hero mockup	White mug, black text
Style	Clean editorial humor print - bold serif headline + medium body + italic punchline
Fonts (Canva)	Playfair Display Black (COFFEE:) + Montserrat SemiBold (body) + Montserrat Italic (punchline)
Colours	#1A1A1A near-black on white (or invert for black mug variant)

AI Prompt:

Flat graphic for printing on white 11oz ceramic mug. Black text and line art on white. No gradients. Centred panel. Large bold serif: COFFEE: / medium weight: Because Stabbing People / is Frowned Upon / italic punchline: (But I Have a Needle License). Small outline coffee cup or syringe above main text. New Yorker cartoon meets modern typographic poster. NOT clipart. Black on white, transparent background.

Product 3 - NICU Nurse T-Shirt (Comfort Colors 1717)

Phrase: "NICU Nurse: Tiny Patients. Massive Heart. Zero Sleep."

Canvas size	4500 x 5400 px 300 DPI PNG transparent
Filename	nurse-nicu-tshirt-v1.png
Hero mockup	Terracotta (Comfort Colors 1717)
Style	Vintage collegiate / distressed retro - warm cream text, slight grain texture
Fonts (Canva)	Bebas Neue (label) + Playfair Display Black Italic (main lines)
Colours	#F5ECD7 warm cream on transparent Garment: terracotta #C26A4C

AI Prompt:

Vintage-style typographic apparel graphic for a terracotta t-shirt. Warm slightly distressed retro aesthetic - 1970s collegiate meets vintage National Park poster. Warm cream text on transparent background. Stacked: NICU NURSE (small top label) / Tiny Patients. / Massive Heart. / Zero Sleep. Optional tiny vintage heart outline between label and main text. Distressed textured type. Warm cream/ivory only. Transparent background. NO baby clipart, stethoscopes, or modern flat design.

4. Etsy Listing Copy (Titles and Tags)

All copy is QC-reviewed. Full descriptions in: ventures/venture-01-pod-store/outputs/COPY-etsy-listings-2026-04-01.md

Listing 1 - Night Shift Sweatshirt

Title: Night Shift Nurse Sweatshirt - Fuelled by Coffee Spite and Monitors Funny RN Crewneck Gift (90 chars)

Tags: night shift nurse | funny nurse crewneck | nurse sweatshirt | RN sweatshirt | nurse gift | funny nurse gift | nurse humor | dark humor nurse | night shift gift | RN gift for her | nurse crewneck | funny RN sweatshirt | healthcare worker

Listing 2 - Sarcastic Nurse Mug

Title: Funny Nurse Mug - Coffee Because Stabbing People Is Frowned Upon Sarcastic RN Needle License (92 chars)

Tags: funny nurse mug | sarcastic nurse gift | nurse coffee mug | RN mug | nurse gift | funny RN mug | nurse humor mug | nurse graduation | nurses week gift | coffee mug nurse | sarcastic mug | gift for nurse | RN coffee mug

Listing 3 - NICU Nurse T-Shirt

Title: NICU Nurse Shirt Tiny Patients Massive Heart Zero Sleep Neonatal Nurse Tee Comfort Colors Gift (94 chars)

Tags: NICU nurse shirt | NICU nurse gift | neonatal nurse tee | funny nurse shirt | NICU nurse tee | Comfort Colors nurse | nurse gift | neonatal nurse gift | NICU shirt | RN gift | funny nurse tee | neonatal nurse shirt | nurses week gift

5. Operator Action Checklist

#	Action	Priority	Notes
1	Create Etsy seller account at etsy.com/sell	CRITICAL	~20 min. Required before any listing goes live.
2	Check Gelato AU mug base cost in Gelato dashboard	HIGH	If COGS >\$20 AUD, reprice mug to \$35 or drop it.
3	Generate Product 1 design (Night Shift Sweatshirt)	HIGH	Use AI prompt or Canva spec in Section 3. Upscale to 4500x5400px.
4	Generate Product 2 design (Nurse Mug)	HIGH	Use AI prompt or Canva spec. 3600x1800px wrap.
5	Generate Product 3 design (NICU Nurse Tee)	HIGH	Use ChatGPT or Midjourney prompt. 4500x5400px.
6	Set up Gelato account + connect to Etsy store	HIGH	Free plan to start. Upgrade to Gelato+ at 5+ sweatshirt sales/month.
7	Upload listings using copy from Section 4	HIGH	Full descriptions in COPY-etsy-listings file. Launch sweatshirt first.
8	Install EverBee Chrome extension	OPTIONAL	Free tier. Improves keyword research for future listings.

TIMING: Nurses Week is the first week of May - approximately 5 weeks away. The sweatshirt listing needs to be live by mid-April to rank in time for the spike. Prioritise actions 1, 3, 6, and 7.